

Rare Evo & Dev Gov Day 2026

Cardano Title Sponsorship

Main Stage & Live Stream

Section 1 — Project Overview

What is the title of your proposal?

Provide the official name of your project as it should appear in governance voting.

Rare Evo & Dev Gov Day 2026 (FREE GA) – Cardano Title Sponsorship – Main Stage & Live Stream

Please describe your whole proposal at high level (Executive Summary)

Provide a high-level overview of the problem, solution and impact your overall proposal is providing with reference to Cardano's vision. Remember this is the first thing DReps will see.

Current Drep supported Cardano's Vision:

"Cardano is the most secure, reliable and censorship-resistant blockchain for mission critical applications to power economies and societies of the future." [read more](#)

The primary mission of this proposal is to strengthen and expand Cardano's global ecosystem presence through Rare Evo 2026 and Rare Dev Gov Day 2026, two established community-led initiatives that have become major coordination, onboarding, networking, governance, and industry outreach platforms for the Cardano ecosystem.

Rare Evo is a multi-chain blockchain conference with deep Cardano roots, produced by Rare Network, originally founded through Cardano ecosystem participation and operation of the Rare Pool stake pool. Entering its sixth consecutive year, Rare Evo has evolved into one of the largest independently operated blockchain conferences in North America and has consistently served as one of the Cardano ecosystem's most visible annual gathering points for builders, governance

participants, enterprises, creators, investors, developers, media, and community members. This proposal would position the Cardano ecosystem as the title sponsor of the Rare Evo 2026 main stage and global livestream, while also supporting the second annual Rare Dev Gov Day, a dedicated Cardano-focused technical, governance, and community coordination event occurring ahead of Rare Evo on July 28th, 2026 at ARIA Las Vegas.

The proposal is designed to create direct ecosystem value through:

- global Cardano brand visibility,
- ecosystem onboarding and education,
- governance participation,
- developer and startup exposure,
- enterprise and institutional outreach,
- cross-chain industry engagement,
- community retention,
- and expanded accessibility for Cardano ecosystem participants.

Treasury support would enable several ecosystem-focused initiatives that otherwise would not occur at the same scale, including:

- free General Admission access for the Cardano community,
- free booth space for Cardano ecosystem projects,
- travel and lodging assistance for participating ecosystem contributors,
- complimentary booth opportunities for selected Cardano projects,
- expanded technical workshops and governance programming,
- dedicated ecosystem networking activations,
- and broader livestream and media distribution focused on Cardano ecosystem visibility.

Rare Evo operates as more than a traditional conference. It functions as a real-world ecosystem coordination platform that connects Cardano builders and governance participants internally while simultaneously introducing external developers, enterprises, investors, and adjacent blockchain communities to the Cardano ecosystem.

This role has become increasingly important during a broader market contraction period where many ecosystem projects face reduced marketing, travel, and business development budgets following the slowdown of traditional ecosystem funding sources. Maintaining strong ecosystem visibility, participation, and coordination infrastructure during difficult market cycles is critical for long-term ecosystem resilience and growth.

The proposal is not intended to create a new initiative from scratch, but rather to expand and strengthen an already proven platform with a multi-year track record of execution and ecosystem impact. Rare Evo 2026 will occur regardless of treasury funding; however, this proposal allows the Cardano ecosystem to substantially expand its presence, accessibility, participation, and strategic industry outreach through a highly leveraged and already operational event infrastructure.

Ultimately, the mission of this proposal is to preserve and strengthen one of Cardano's most established community-led ecosystem platforms while creating measurable value across adoption, governance participation, developer engagement, enterprise visibility, and long-term ecosystem growth.

Please see the treasury funding request, along with Cardano's benefits from it on the pages below:

Rare Network is requesting \$755k USD from the Cardano treasury. This will cover two sponsorship for Cardano. One sponsorship for Rare Evo 2026 as the title sponsorship and a second title sponsorship for Cardano Dev Gov Day 2.

Key Highlights for Value Brought to Cardano:

- Free GA Admission to Rare Evo & Cardano Dev Gov Day 2026
- Free Expo Hall Booth Space for Cardano Ecosystem Startup Projects
- Free Cardano Main Stage Programming
- Free Breakout Room & Workshop Space
- An entire day dedicated to Cardano Programming for Rare Dev Gov Day ahead of Rare Evo
- Live Stream to Allow Global Community to Tune In
- Title Sponsorship & Mainstage Programming Showcasing Cardano with the Loudest Brand Power
- Live Stream Cardano Ads for Global Exposure Beyond the IRL Conference
- To be continued...

Cost Breakdown:

\$325k for Rare Dev Gov Day 2 Sponsorship

\$250k for Rare Evo 2026 Cardano Title Sponsorship – Mainstage & Live Stream

\$180k for Intersect, Audit, Fees, Tax Withholdings & Dev Gov Day 2027 Deposit

Cardano Dev Gov Day 2 (2026) Sponsorship

Related Expense Type	Price	Description
Venue Space Break Out Rooms & Ballroom	\$75,000	Funds that will go to Aria for the general space rental of breakout rooms and usage of the main ballroom on July 28th.
Breakout AV Staging & Signage Production	\$50,000	Equipping and staffing each workshop breakout space with proper AV, such as microphones, projectors, streaming/recording, WiFi, power, signage both printed and digital, etc..

Videography & Photography	\$25,000	Professional film and photography services with pre-event planning, at event execution, and post event editing/content delivery. Management of recorded sessions and multiple Cardano promotional materials. 4x videographers & 4 photographers for 24 hours of work onsite, plus pre-planning and post-production.
Travel & Lodging - 20 Community Members	\$50,000	20 Cardano community members who are volunteering at Dev Gov Day or Rare Evo 2026 will be provided with travel and lodging credit to Las Vegas with roundtrip flights and hotels from July 27th-31st. This will be a diverse mix, for example 5 Content Creators/Marketers, 5 dReps, 5 Developers, and 5 Project Leads.
Food & Beverage	\$50,000	Funding allocated for food and beverage for 500 throughout the day. Breakfast & Lunch with drinks throughout the day like coffee and water.
Happy Hour & Kickoff Party Co-Sponsorship	\$75,000	Dev Gov Day Happy Hour & Kickoff Party Cardano Sponsorship. Snacks and open bar to celebrate the completion of Dev Gov Day 2 and the Kick Off of Rare Evo 2026.

Rare Evo 2026 Cardano Title Sponsorship – Mainstage & Live Stream

Related Expense Type	Price	Description
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Main Stage Sponsorship	\$200,000	Cardano Top Billing as Conference Premier Sponsor Free 10x10ft or 10x20ft Booths for All Cardano Projects Free GA Tickets to All Cardano Community 10 Aria Hotel Rooms for July 27th-28th to Cardano Community Giveaway 50 Free VIP Tickets to Cardano Community Giveaway (Breakfast & Lunch Included for 2 Days) 5x 25 Minute Mainstage Panel Slots 2 Hours of Workshop Space per PENTAD Entity Cardano Video Ad's on the Main Stage LED Cardano Main Stage Seat Covers LED Wall Rental LED Floor Signage and Towers Stage & Production Crew Labor Logistics and Shipping
Live Stream Sponsorship	\$50,000	Cardano Exclusive L1 Ads on Live Stream (Between Panels & Speeches) Direct Mainstage Internet Line PTZ Cameras & Operators Live Stream Production Team Additional Equipment for Multiple Stream Keys

(max 2000 characters)

Why are you the best suited to deliver this work? (Track Record)

Describe what previous experience and expertise you or your team have which is relevant for your proposal. Focus on proven history of delivery, mention previous successful proposals, mainnet deployments, or relevant enterprise experience.

Rare Network has been active in the Cardano ecosystem since 2020, beginning with the launch of the RARE stake pool and evolving into one of the most consistent producers of Cardano-focused community building and ecosystem growth events, activations, and ecosystem media. Over the past half decade, the organization has built extensive operational infrastructure, industry relationships, and community trust through the successful execution of conferences, governance initiatives, side events, ecosystem showcases, and global blockchain activations. The team is the creator and operator of Rare Evo, one of the largest independently operated Cardano community-led conferences, held annually for five consecutive years. What began as a grassroots ecosystem initiative has grown into a major North American blockchain conference that brings together developers, founders, enterprises, investors, governance participants, creators, media, and community members from across the digital asset industry.

Rare Evo has consistently provided a highly visible platform for Cardano ecosystem participation while simultaneously introducing external blockchain communities, enterprises, and developers to Cardano technology, governance, and ecosystem projects within a broader multi-chain environment. The conference has hosted major Cardano ecosystem participants, including leadership from organizations such as PENTAD, while also creating accessible opportunities for startups and community projects through discounted or complimentary booths, sponsorships, speaking opportunities, workshops, and ecosystem networking activations. Recent editions of Rare Evo have featured more than 70 exhibitor booths, multiple stages, livestream production, technical workshops, industry panels, networking experiences, and large-scale community activations.

In 2025, the team launched the first Cardano Dev Gov Day, a dedicated Cardano-focused technical and governance event held ahead of Rare Evo. The event was intentionally designed as a free and publicly accessible community coordination platform with no requirement to hold a Rare Evo conference ticket. Cardano Dev Gov Day successfully brought together developers, governance contributors, ecosystem organizations, and community members for a full day of workshops, panels, networking, and ecosystem collaboration. The inaugural event welcomed approximately 500 attendees and featured a keynote from Charles Hoskinson alongside governance discussions,

technical education, ecosystem workshops, and community-building activities designed to strengthen collaboration and participation throughout the Cardano ecosystem.

Beyond Rare Evo itself, the organization has maintained active involvement in Cardano governance and ecosystem growth initiatives. Team members participated in the formation of Intersect's Growth & Marketing Committee and have contributed to governance workshops and ecosystem coordination efforts internationally, including activations across North America, Europe, and Asia. As a formal contributor to Cardano's Unified Global Events Marketing Strategy, the team has also produced Cardano ecosystem booths, networking events, and side activations at major global blockchain conferences year-round. Additional ecosystem initiatives have included the pilot launch of Amplify Cardano, a community-led open ecosystem marketing and events fund designed to support projects and individuals seeking funding for grassroots activations, campaigns, and educational events. Operationally, the team successfully coordinated the global Project Catalyst Fund 12 launch campaign, which included 15 in-person events and 12 virtual activations worldwide. Additional community support efforts have included sponsorship and collaboration with independent ecosystem events such as GM Cardano and other grassroots community-building initiatives surrounding major Cardano ecosystem gatherings.

Collectively, the organization has produced more than 60 blockchain industry side events and activations at conferences including ETHDenver, TOKEN2049, Consensus, Duke Blockchain Conference, Paris Blockchain Week, Cardano Summit, and more. These efforts have consistently helped position Cardano within broader industry conversations while creating meaningful opportunities for developer onboarding, business development, investor engagement, governance participation, and cross-ecosystem collaboration.

A key differentiator behind these efforts is the existing operational infrastructure, venue relationships, sponsor network, production capabilities, volunteer coordination, and industry partnerships that have already been established over multiple years of execution. This existing infrastructure significantly reduces execution risk while enabling ecosystem initiatives to operate at a scale, professionalism, and industry reach that would otherwise require substantially greater resources to replicate from scratch.

Rare Evo Historical Metrics

(To be completed)

- *Annual attendance: 2500*
- *Exhibitor booth count: 75*
- *Number of speakers:*
- *Number of ecosystem partners:*
- *Livestream reach/views:*
- *Social media impressions:*
- *Number of Cardano projects represented:*
- *Sponsorship growth:*
- *Countries represented:*
- *Number of side events/community activations:*
- *Media coverage/interviews:*
- *Enterprise participants:*
- *Developer participation metrics:*

Cardano Dev Gov Day Historical Metrics

(To be completed)

- *Attendance:*
- *Number of workshops:*
- *Number of governance sessions:*
- *Number of participating ecosystem organizations:*
- *Community networking participation:*
- *Livestream metrics:*
- *Technical workshop attendance:*
- *Governance participation metrics:*
- *Speaker count:*
- *Community satisfaction/feedback metrics:*
- *Social reach/impressions:*
- *Number of ecosystem collaborations initiated:*

(max 5000 characters)

How long will your proposal need to be fully delivered? Or if you are requesting funding for operations, how many months will this budget cover?

Provide an estimated duration from the start of the work to completion. Or if your proposal covers ongoing operations or services, specify the number of months this budget is intended to support.

If funds are expected to be received in early June, then we would have 2 months of execution, between continued planning, hosting the event, and post-event reporting. However, Rare Evo is a year-long effort and Rare Dev Gov Day takes around 4 months of planning.

Section 2 — Alignment to Strategy Framework

To which strategic pillar does your proposal align the most?

Looking at the strategy pillars supported by DReps in this info action, which one does your proposal support or relate to the most. Before selecting, read the whole strategy framework and review the pillars details. Select one or more

Multiple selections:

- **Pillar 1: Infrastructure & Research Excellence** - Keep Cardano secure, fast, and interoperable so it can host more economic activity.
- **Pillar 2: Adoption & Utility** - Driving widespread, non-speculative utility by focusing on high-value industry verticals, superior user experience (UX), and enterprise-grade security.
- **Pillar 3: Governance** - Cardano governance must be hard to capture, easy to use, and paced. This builds directly on Cardano's tripartite model of DReps, Constitutional Committee, and SPOs.
- **Pillar 4: Community & Ecosystem Growth** - Driving global engagement through a market-centric approach, cultivating a skilled developer base, and proactively demonstrating ecosystem value.
- **Pillar 5: Ecosystem Sustainability & Resilience** - Ensuring the long-term financial health and operational integrity of the network infrastructure.

- Pillar 3: Governance
- Pillar 4: Community & Ecosystem Growth
- Pillar 5: Ecosystem Sustainability & Resilience

Why have you selected those pillars? (Rationale for your selection)

Provide a rationale about why those pillars align the most to your proposal and how your proposal supports them. Look also at the focus areas provided as examples for each pillar.

Focus on how your proposal provides value towards those pillars.

Pillar 3 — Governance

This proposal aligns with Pillar 3 by creating accessible opportunities for governance participation, ecosystem coordination, and community collaboration through Rare Dev Gov Day and Rare Evo 2026.

Cardano governance depends not only on on-chain systems, but also on education, communication, and real-world collaboration between DReps, SPOs, builders, projects, and community members. Cardano Dev Gov Day was specifically created to support these goals through governance workshops, technical sessions, networking, and open ecosystem discussions.

The proposal expands those efforts by supporting:

- governance-focused programming,
- free public participation,
- ecosystem contributor attendance,
- collaborative workshops and panels,

- and stronger communication between ecosystem stakeholders.

The team has also demonstrated direct governance involvement through participation in Intersect initiatives, governance workshops, and broader ecosystem coordination efforts.

Pillar 4 — Community & Ecosystem Growth

This proposal strongly aligns with Pillar 4 by increasing ecosystem visibility, onboarding, education, and industry engagement through Rare Evo and Cardano Dev Gov Day.

Over the past five years, Rare Evo has become one of the most recognized community-led blockchain events with strong Cardano participation and representation. The event brings together developers, founders, enterprises, investors, creators, and community members while exposing external blockchain audiences to Cardano technology, governance, and ecosystem projects.

Treasury support would expand accessibility and participation through:

- free General Admission access for the Cardano community,
- travel and lodging support for ecosystem contributors,
- complimentary booth opportunities for selected projects,
- technical workshops and ecosystem programming,
- and expanded livestream and media distribution.

The proposal also supports ecosystem growth by positioning Cardano prominently within broader multi-chain industry conversations, creating opportunities for developer onboarding, startup visibility, enterprise engagement, and cross-ecosystem collaboration.

Pillar 5 — Ecosystem Sustainability & Resilience

This proposal aligns with Pillar 5 by strengthening long-standing ecosystem infrastructure during a period of reduced funding availability and broader market contraction.

Rare Evo has operated continuously for five years as an independently organized community initiative that supports ecosystem coordination, education, networking, and industry visibility. Rather than building a new initiative from scratch, this proposal expands an already operational platform with proven infrastructure, established industry relationships, and an experienced execution team. The proposal also helps lower barriers to ecosystem participation by supporting:

- free community access,
- project booth opportunities,
- contributor travel assistance,
- and broader educational programming.

By leveraging existing infrastructure and operational experience, the proposal represents a highly efficient use of treasury resources while helping maintain ecosystem visibility, collaboration, and participation through challenging market conditions.

(max 10000 characters)

Does your proposal support any of the KPIs of the strategy framework?

Looking at the KPIs provided in the strategy framework, explain:

- if your proposal directly supports any of those and how
- AND / OR propose other additions to the existing list, describe why they are relevant and how your proposal relates to them.

For each selected KPI, explain the specific actions, methods, or approaches you will use to drive meaningful impact.

(max 10000 characters)

Section 3 — Proposer

What's the display name of the proposer?

Depending if you are submitting this proposal as an individual or a company, this could either be your name or your company name

Rare Network / Rare Evo

Would you like to link any social media on your proposal page?

<https://rareevo.io/>

<https://rareevo.io/dev-gov-day>

<https://x.com/RareNetworkWeb3>

<https://x.com/RareEvo>

<https://www.youtube.com/@RareNetworkMedia>

<https://rareevo.io/news>

What's the best email an Intersect admin can use to contact you?

This will be used for anything related to this proposal submission

contact@rarenetwork.io

Section 4 — Proposal Details

What ADA to USD conversion rate are you using for your overall proposal?

Please specify the rate used for all USD estimations in this proposal. This helps DReps understand the approximate dollar value of your budget.

[.24 USD](#)

How can your proposal be broken down in work packages?

One proposal may include one or multiple work packages or work streams. Please provide details for each one below.

Work Package #1

This section is about breaking down your proposed work and its value to Cardano.

(Repeat this section conceptually for each Work Package in your proposal)

What is the name of this Work Package?

Provide a short, descriptive name for this unit of work (e.g. "WP1 – Node Performance Improvements").

Cardano Dev Gov Day 2026

Please describe this Work Package at a high level

Describe the main activities and, where relevant, the key outputs or deliverables. The goal is to give reviewers enough context to understand what this work covers, without requiring a detailed delivery plan.

(max 2000 characters)

What is this work package intended to achieve? (Core Objectives)

Describe the objectives of this Work Package. List each objective separately and focus on outcomes or improvements, rather than tasks or activities.

(max 2000 characters)

Why does this Work Package matter to Cardano? (Expected Value)

Describe what will change or improve for Cardano as a result of this work package, and why that change justifies the investment. Then define one or more metrics that will be used to assess whether the expected value has been achieved.

(max 2000 characters)

How will you measure success for this Work Package? (Metric)

Provide one or more metrics that demonstrate whether the expected value has been achieved. Metrics may be qualitative or quantitative.

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(max 2000 characters)

Is this a new initiative or a continuation of an existing one?

Indicate whether this proposal represents a new project or ongoing maintenance.

--

How would you classify the primary nature of this work proposal?

This helps reviewers understand whether the work is primarily technical or non-technical.

--

How will this work package be delivered? *

Break this Work Package into milestones or delivery phases. This helps reviewers understand how progress will be structured and validated, and provides a clear basis for contracting and payment if the proposal is approved.

If you choose to include milestones, please describe each milestone using the following information:

- **Milestone name**
Provide a short reference name for the milestone. You may use labels such as "Milestone 1," but please include a descriptive name (for example: *"Milestone 1 – Design Approval"*).
- **Deliverables**
Describe the concrete outputs produced as part of this milestone, such as reports, code, documentation, audits, or other tangible artifacts.
- **Acceptance criteria**
Explain how reviewers will know this milestone is complete. Describe the objective conditions that must be met for approval and, where applicable, payment.

- **Estimated duration**

Indicate how long you expect this milestone to take in weeks.

Milestone #1

(Repeat this section for each milestone in your work package)

<i>Milestone Name</i>	
<i>Deliverables</i>	
<i>Acceptance Criteria</i>	
<i>Estimated Duration (weeks)</i>	

What's the budget estimated for this Work Package?

Breakdown your estimated budget into the appropriate categories. Make sure to Provide context so DReps can understand why each item is added and how it is calculated.

Item #1

(Repeat this section for each item in your work package)

<i>Cost Category</i>	<i>Resources (Labor)</i>
<i>Item Description</i>	
<i>Item Quantity</i>	
<i>Unit Cost</i>	ADA
<i>Item total cost</i>	ADA

Is there any supporting material you would like to share for this Work Package?

Link any relevant documentation, diagrams, technical specifications, or additional context that supports this Work Package.

Section 5 — Budget Summary

Will any portion of the requested funds be returned to the Cardano Treasury?

Select whether your proposal includes any form of treasury repayment (for example, unused funds, profit-sharing, or conditional returns).

If applicable, under what circumstances would repayment occur?

Describe the conditions or triggers that would result in funds being returned to the treasury.

(max 10000 characters)

Have you previously received funding from Cardano or related ecosystem programs?

List any prior funding received from Catalyst, Treasury withdrawals, Intersect programs, or other Cardano ecosystem grants. If not applicable, you may enter “N/A”.

Yes, Rare Network has received funding from the Unified Global Events strategy, in addition to past Project Catalyst grants for events, media, and software production.

(max 10000 characters)

Section 6 — Budget Administration

Who will be the administrator for this budget proposal if approved?

Cardano's Constitution requires each Treasury Withdrawal to specify an Administrator and a third-party auditor. Fields marked with the eye-off icon contain information that will not be publicly visible and will only be used for administration or contracting purposes if the proposal is approved.

Intersect

(max 4000 characters)

Are you applying as a company or as an individual?

Select the contracting party type.

Company

Who is the primary contact for this proposal?

Provide the full name of the person responsible for day-to-day communication.

Wes Parkinson

What is the primary contact email address?

This email will be used for notifications and official correspondence.

wes@rarenetwork.io

What is the transaction hash for your treasury donation?

Provide the transaction hash confirming the required treasury donation (1000 ada), which serves as proof of wallet control and commitment.

How will independent audits or assurance be handled for this proposal?

Cardano's Constitution requires Treasury Withdrawal Actions to allocate funds for periodic independent audits and oversight metrics. Describe whether funds are being set aside for independent audits or third-party assurance, and how oversight of treasury funds will be ensured.

Audit will occur through Intersect MBO with usual fee structure. Funds will be allocated to the audit, legal, tax, and trade fees expected in relation to fund distribution and audit reporting.

(max 1000 characters)

Section 7 - Other Supporting Info

Other Supporting Info?

Link additional supporting documentation

<https://rareevo.io/dev-gov-day>